

Fast Track v1 Spec

Purpose

Fast Track v1 is a read-first discovery surface inside GDA Command that identifies emerging technology signals, links those signals to companies, and recommends contract pathways where GDA can connect capability to demand.[file:5] [file:2] It is an upstream surface that should feed later opportunity qualification, not replace Ops Tracker, Pipeline, or Opportunity Detail.[file:1] [file:64] [file:2]

Current state

The current Launchpad implementation includes a `fastTrackSignals` summary count, but Fast Track does not yet exist as a full product surface with its own list view, detail view, or API contract.[file:37] [file:39] Existing shipped surfaces already establish the operating pattern GDA should reuse: React as the main UI, safe `/api/...` routes, standard response envelopes, and explicit safety rules around reads, dry-runs, and approved writes.[file:5] [file:37] [file:64]

Product definition

Fast Track should answer one operator question: “What emerging capability matters, who appears to have it, and where can that capability attach to real government demand?”[file:5] The product’s core unit is not just a signal, company, or opportunity by itself; it is a **match candidate** that ties together a signal, a technology, a company, and a contract-path hypothesis.[file:2] [file:5]

In scope for v1

- Detect and display emerging tech signals from sources such as innovation factories, academia, pre-RFI activity, post-RFI activity, and related market movement.[file:5]
- Associate a signal with one or more relevant companies, including GDA, partners, targets, competitors, or unknown entities.[file:5]
- Recommend a likely buyer, mission owner, requirement, vehicle, or contract path where the technology could matter.[file:2] [file:5]
- Present source-backed reasoning and a recommended next action in a read-only workflow.[file:2] [file:5]
- Allow the operator to decide whether to keep watching, discard, or later promote the match into downstream opportunity management.[file:1] [file:64]

Out of scope for v1

- No automatic creation of opportunities in production.[file:64] [file:5]
- No direct browser calls to n8n, webhooks, or secrets.[file:5] [file:37]
- No paid research calls, sends, deploys, or production writes without a later approval-gated design.[file:5] [file:64]
- No replacement of Ops Tracker, Pipeline, or Opportunity Detail.[file:1] [file:64] [file:2]

Surface split

Surface	Role
Fast Track	Upstream signal → technology → company → contract-path matching.[file:5]
Ops Tracker	Opportunity discovery and operator management, including qualification workflow with safety gates.[file:64]
Pipeline	Read-only list of already qualified opportunities.[file:1]
Opportunity Detail / OODA	Source-backed explanation, structured analysis, and recommended action for a selected opportunity.[file:2]

Fast Track should therefore be treated as a distinct planning surface that produces candidates for review before they become managed opportunities.[file:5] [file:2]

Non-negotiables

1. React remains the main UI; Retool remains archived/reference only.[file:5]
2. Every Fast Track endpoint must use the standard GDA envelope: `success`, `workflow`, `action`, `dryRun`, `data`, `meta`, `error`. [file:37] [file:2]
3. React must only call safe relative `/api/...` routes.[file:5] [file:37]
4. v1 should be read-only or dry-run only; it must not introduce production writes.[file:5] [file:64]
5. Any factual claim derived from external material must be traceable to a source object, following the same discipline already required by Opportunity Detail/OODA.[file:2]
6. Safety lane classification must be explicit from day one.[file:5]
7. Postgres should hold durable Fast Track business state once the surface moves beyond pure mock mode.[file:5]

Record model

The primary record in Fast Track v1 is a `match_candidate`. [file:5] [file:2]

Required fields

Field	Type	Meaning
id	string	Canonical Fast Track match ID.[file:2]
status	string	new, reviewing, watching, promoted, or discarded. [file:5]
signal_type	string	Signal category such as innovation factory, academia, pre-RFI, post-RFI, SBIR, funding event, or competitor move.[file:5]
signal_summary	string	Plain-English statement of the signal.[file:2]
technology	string	Capability or technical area indicated by the signal.[file:5]
company_name	string	Company believed to hold or represent the capability.[file:5]
company_role	string	internal, partner, target, competitor, or unknown. [file:5]
candidate_agency	string null	Likely buyer or mission owner.[file:2]
candidate_requirement	string null	Likely requirement, vehicle, program, or opportunity path.[file:2] [file:5]
contract_path_hypothesis	string	Plain-English explanation of how the tech-company combination could attach to demand.[file:2]
match_score	number	Confidence score for the overall fit.[file:5]
recommended_next_action	string	Most important operator next step.[file:2]
safety_lane	string	read-only or dry-run in v1.[file:5]
sources	array	Source records supporting the match; must be present even when empty.[file:2]
created_at	string	Record creation timestamp.[file:2]
updated_at	string	Last update timestamp.[file:2]

Optional fields

Field	Type	Meaning
technology_tags	string[]	Controlled tags for clustering and filtering.[file:5]
company_url	string null	Canonical company site if known.[file:2]
incumbent_or_competitor_context	string null	Why the company matters competitively.[file:5]
buyer_problem	string null	Suspected mission pain point the tech could address.[file:2]
next_review_at	string null	Planned follow-up date for watch items.[file:5]

Field	Type	Meaning
promotion_target	string null	Target downstream destination, likely Ops Tracker. [file:1][file:64]

Source model

Every record should support a `sources` array even when there are zero sources, because hiding source structure weakens traceability and violates the pattern already defined for Opportunity Detail/OODA.[file:2] Each source object should include enough metadata to explain what the source is, where it came from, and which claim it supports.[file:2]

Suggested source fields:

- `source_id`
- `type`
- `title`
- `url`
- `publisher`
- `published_at`
- `retrieved_at`
- `claim_support` (short note describing what it supports)

API contract

Fast Track v1 should start with three read-only endpoints.[file:5][file:37]

1. GET `/api/fast-track/summary`

Returns top-line summary cards for the Fast Track surface.[file:37]

Example data shape:

```
{
  "new_count": 12,
  "reviewing_count": 4,
  "watching_count": 9,
  "promoted_count": 2,
  "discarded_count": 3,
  "needs_attention_count": 5
}
```

2. GET /api/fast-track/matches

Returns the list view for operator review.[file:5]

Supported initial filters:

- status
- signal_type
- technology
- company_role
- min_match_score

Example response envelope:

```
{
  "success": true,
  "workflow": "gda-fast-track",
  "action": "list",
  "dryRun": false,
  "data": {
    "matches": []
  },
  "meta": {
    "count": 0,
    "generatedAt": "ISO8601",
    "filtersApplied": {}
  },
  "error": null
}
```

3. GET /api/fast-track/:id

Returns the detail view for one match candidate.[file:2]

Example data shape:

```
{
  "match": { },
  "analysis": {
    "executive_summary": "...",
    "why_it_matters": "...",
    "risks_or_gaps": []
  },
  "ooda": {
    "observe": [],
    "orient": [],
    "decide": "...",
    "act": "..."
  },
  "sources": [],
  "learning": {
```

```
    "notes": [],  
    "reserved": true  
  }  
}
```

This mirrors the established GDA detail pattern: source-backed facts, explicit analysis blocks, OODA separation, and reserved learning fields.[file:2]

React UX

Fast Track v1 should be a dedicated React route and not just a Launchpad counter.[file:37]
[file:39] The page should follow the same command-center pattern already used elsewhere: KPI strip on top, local summary strip under it, then a main working surface.[file:37] [file:1]
[file:2]

List view

Recommended columns:

Column	Purpose
Signal	What happened.[file:5]
Technology	What capability is emerging.[file:5]
Company	Who appears to have it.[file:5]
Candidate buyer	Who may care.[file:2]
Contract path	Where the match could attach.[file:2]
Score	Confidence / priority.[file:5]
Status	Operator workflow state.[file:5]
Next action	Best immediate move.[file:2]

Detail view

The detail page or side panel should include:

- Executive summary.[file:2]
- Observe: source-backed facts only.[file:2]
- Orient: interpretation of why the signal, company, and buyer fit together.[file:2]
- Decide: recommended operator decision.[file:2]
- Act: immediate next action.[file:2]
- Sources section, including explicit empty state when none exist.[file:2]

Workflow behavior

Fast Track v1 should operate in the read-only safety lane for live use, with optional dry-run previews reserved for later promotion actions.[file:5] The initial operator flow should be:

1. Review new match candidates.[file:5]
2. Open a match candidate to inspect sources and rationale.[file:2]
3. Mark it conceptually as keep watching, discard, or prepare for downstream promotion.
[file:5]
4. Later, in a separate sprint, add a promotion action that creates or stages an Ops Tracker opportunity via dry-run or approval-required behavior.[file:64] [file:1]

Data ownership

Postgres should be the system of record for durable Fast Track state, because the North Star explicitly requires important business state to live in the database rather than scattered workflow memory.[file:5] n8n should remain the workflow engine for signal collection, enrichment, and matching logic, while the API gateway normalizes responses for React.
[file:5]

Proposed status model

Status	Meaning
new	Newly surfaced and not yet reviewed.[file:5]
reviewing	Actively being evaluated by the operator.[file:5]
watching	Not ready for promotion, but worth monitoring.[file:5]
promoted	Moved downstream into opportunity management.[file:1] [file:64]
discarded	Reviewed and intentionally not pursued.[file:5]

Acceptance criteria for v1

- Fast Track exists as its own React route and page, not just a count in Launchpad.[file:37] [file:39]
- The UI reads only from safe /api/... endpoints.[file:5] [file:37]
- Summary, list, and detail endpoints all return the standard GDA envelope.[file:37] [file:2]
- Every detail record renders source-backed reasoning and an explicit sources section, including empty-state behavior.[file:2]
- No production writes are introduced.[file:64] [file:5]
- Safety lane for each workflow used by Fast Track is explicitly classified.[file:5]
- The surface clearly hands off to downstream opportunity management rather than duplicating it.[file:1] [file:64] [file:2]

Sprint recommendation

The correct sprint target is Fast Track v1: read-only signal-to-contract matching.[file:5][file:64]
That keeps the build aligned with current platform priorities: stabilize the foundation, preserve API normalization and safety discipline, and add a meaningful new operator surface without introducing risky writes too early.[file:5][file:37][file:64]

Execution order

1. Approve this product spec and route name.[file:5]
2. Build the React page in mock mode first, using the existing GDA page conventions.
[file:37][file:1]
3. Add GET /api/fast-track/summary and GET /api/fast-track/matches behind the standard envelope.[file:37][file:5]
4. Add GET /api/fast-track/:id with source-backed detail and OODA-lite structure.[file:2]
5. Add smoke tests for envelope shape and safe read-only behavior before any live hookup.
[file:64][file:1]
6. Defer promotion/write behavior to a later approval-gated sprint.[file:64][file:5]